

ARUN KUMAR

EXPERTS HOPE THAT THE VIRTUOUS CYCLE OF CONSUMPTION THE BUDGET TRIGGERS LIFTS INDIA'S SAGGING GDP GROWTH

growth: agriculture, manufacturing, exports and investment. In agriculture, realising the need to take states along, the budget announced a PM Dhan-Dhanya Krishi Yojana in partnership with states to boost productivity, promote crop diversity and improve irrigation and storage facilities. Pulses continued to receive a thrust, with the government launching a six-year mission for *aatmanirbharta* (self-reliance), particularly in tur, urad and masoor that India now massively imports.

Budget 2025 also stuck to its commitment to boost production by announcing a National Manufacturing Mission that would hard-focus on creating five key pre-requisites: ease of doing business, future-ready workforce, a vibrant micro, small and medium enterprises (MSME) segment, technology adoption and quality products. For ease of doing business, the government has set up a high-level committee for regulatory reforms that will review the maze of rules, certifications, licences and permissions in the non-financial sectors that create major hurdles for businesses. For the MSME sector, in addition to revising the classification criteria by enhancing investment and turnover thresholds to enable more businesses to benefit from government schemes, the FM further eased access to credit by doubling the credit guarantee for collateral-free loans from Rs 5 crore to Rs 10 crore. Export-led MSMEs will get cover for term loans of up to Rs 20 crore.

To provide exports a leg-up, Budget 2025 announced an Export Promotion Mission with sectoral and ministry-spe-